

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

How We Work

The Bench, the task flow, and what done means

EW-TECH-01 · v1.0 · 2026-09-10

Owner: Brad Palmer · For: Every tech contractor



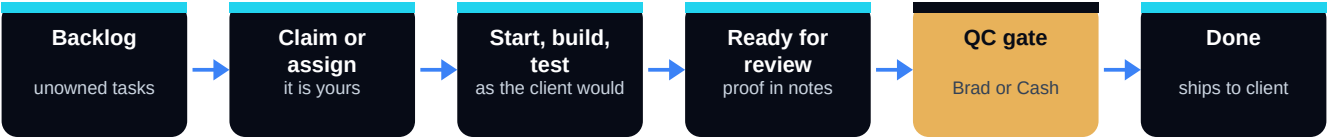
WHAT THIS IS

This is how the tech team works day to day. All work runs through The Bench, the tech portal at easyworks.ai/team/work. This document covers your first login, how a task moves from backlog to done, what done means, how to communicate, and the few things that get someone removed from the team. Read it once in full, then keep it open until the flow is second nature.

DONE MEANS

You can take any task from Claim to Ready for review on your own, with proof attached, and you hit Blocked the moment you are stuck instead of going quiet.

01 The operating rule



The task flow. Every task on The Bench follows this path. Only the gold gate can mark a task done.

Brad	Cash	Technical Builder	Web Developer	Automation Dev
CTO. Holds scope approval, go live QC and escalations. Clears Blocked tasks.	Head of Sales. Approves tasks at the QC gate with Brad. Sees every board.	GHL builds plus code. Claims, builds, tests, moves to review.	Client sites and funnels. Same flow, per site repo and deploy.	Integrations and AI. Same flow, scoped keys per client.

THE OPERATING RULE

Brad holds three gates: scope approval, go live QC, and escalations. Everything else the team solves. If you are waiting on Brad for anything outside those three, ask yourself which SOP should have answered it, and say so in the task.

The Bench is the only place work is tracked. If it is not on the board, it does not exist. If it is not in the task notes, it did not happen. You never need to open a spreadsheet, a group chat, or an email thread to know what to do next.

02 The task flow

Status	What it means	Who moves it
Backlog	Scoped and ready. If it has no owner, any tech contractor can claim it.	Brad or Cash create it. You claim it, or they assign it.
In progress	Someone is building it. Notes are being added as it moves.	You, when you press Start.
Review	Built and tested by you, proof attached, waiting for QC. Locked for you while it waits.	You, when you press Ready for review. Brad gets pinged.
Blocked	You cannot continue. A reason is written. Brad is pinged instantly.	You, when you press Blocked and type why.
Done	Passed QC. This is the only status that means it ships.	Brad or Cash only.

Tasks are created by Brad or Cash from an approved and paid scope. A task has a title, the client, a priority, a due date, what done looks like, and a link to the SOP it follows. If any of those is missing, ask for it in the notes before you start.

SENT BACK IS NOT A PROBLEM

A task in Review can be sent back with a note. That is normal, especially in your first week. Read the note, fix exactly what it says, add a note saying what you changed, move it back to Ready for review.

03 First login on The Bench

You get a one time access code from Brad, in the form EW-XXXX-0000. It is shown to Brad only once, so keep it. The platform walks you through setup on your first login and you cannot see the board until every step is complete. That is enforced on the server, not just on the screen.

1**Go to easyworks.ai/team/work and enter your code**

Type it all caps, exactly as sent, including the dashes.

End state: you see the Welcome screen with a four step tracker.

2**Your details**

Email, contact (WhatsApp), country, time zone, main skill, and how you want to be paid.

Required: email, contact, skill. You can fix the rest later under My profile.

End state: the tracker shows step one complete.

3**Sign the documents**

Three documents, signed in the portal: the NDA, the non solicit, and the contractor agreement.

Read them. Your name, the date and your device are recorded with the signature.

End state: documents show as signed.

4**The four card tour**

Four cards: Your Work board, Work a task, Stuck? Say so, Getting it approved. About sixty seconds.

You can replay it any time with the Replay tour button.

End state: the last card says Start working and you land on the Work board.

5**Check what you see**

You see only Work. There is no sales side for tech contractors, that is by design.

You should see your first task, or an unowned task in Backlog.

End state: you can read a task card with its priority chip, client, due date and linked SOP.

RULE

The access code is personal. Never share it, never paste it in a chat, never log in as someone else. If you lose it or it stops working, message Brad directly.

04 Working a task

The buttons on a task card are the whole workflow. Their names below are exactly as they appear on The Bench.

1**Claim it, or receive it**

An unowned task in Backlog shows a **Claim it** button. Press it and the task is yours.

Brad or Cash may assign a task to you instead. It appears on your board with your name on it.

End state: the card shows "with" your name.

2**Open the linked SOP and read the whole thing**

Do this before you touch the client system.

Check you have the access the SOP assumes (see EW-TECH-02 Access and Security). If not, ask in the notes now.

End state: you know the steps and the Definition of done for this task.

3

Press Start

The task moves to In progress.

Post a first note if anything is unclear. Ask early, it is cheaper than rework.

End state: status shows In progress.

4

Build it, following the SOP

Work in the client sub account or the client repo you were invited to. Nothing else.

Add a note whenever something meaningful moves. Short is fine.

5

Test it as the client would

Not as a developer. Fill the form on your phone. Call the number. Send the text. Book the slot. Watch what the client gets.

If the SOP has a QA checklist, run it (EW-TECH-09 QA and the Go Live Gate).

End state: you have seen it work end to end with your own eyes.

6

Attach proof in the notes

Screenshots, or a short Loom, showing the end to end result.

Type in the **Add a note** box and press **Post**.

If the SOP was wrong or thin, say so here (see section 07).

End state: anyone reading the notes could verify the task without asking you.

7

Press Ready for review

The task moves to Review and Brad is pinged.

The card locks for you while it waits for QC. Move to your next task.

End state: status shows In review.

8

Act on the QC result

Approved: Brad or Cash press Approve and the task is Done.

Sent back: read the note, fix it, note what changed, press Ready for review again.

End state: the task is Done, or back in Review with your fix.

WATCH OUT

Never tell a client something is live. Never say done in a chat. The only done is the Done status on The Bench, set by Brad or Cash after QC. Published is not the same as visible: open it as the client would before you claim it works.

05 What done means, and priorities

Definition of done, every task

- ☐ It works end to end, not just the part you changed.
- ☐ You tested it as the client would use it (phone, real form, real call, real text).
- ☐ The SOP was updated, or a note says what was wrong, if the task taught us something.
- ☐ Screenshots or a Loom are in the task notes, showing the result.
- ☐ The task is moved to Ready for review. Not announced in chat.

Priorities

Priority	Meaning	What you do
P1	Client facing and time bound. A client is waiting or something is broken for them.	Drop everything. Start it now. Post a note within the hour saying what you found.
P2	Normal build work from an approved scope.	Work in due date order. This is most of your day.
P3	Internal work, improvements, tooling.	Whenever there is no P1 or P2 waiting. First tasks for new contractors are usually P3.

06 The Blocked rule and how we communicate

THE BLOCKED RULE

Blocked means blocked. The moment you cannot continue, press **Blocked**, type what is stopping you, and move to your next task. Brad is pinged instantly and clears it. Sitting silent on a blocker wastes your day and delays a client. It is the fastest way to lose trust on this team.

Pressed Blocked by mistake? Post a note and press Start. A good Blocked reason has three parts: what you were trying to do, what happened instead, and what you need. For example: "Setting up missed call text back per EW-TECH-05 step 3. The workflow will not publish, error on the SMS step. Need to know if the A2P registration is complete for this client."

Communication rules

- **One channel.** The task notes are the channel. Questions, progress, proof, blockers, all go in the notes on the task they belong to. Not WhatsApp, not email, not a side chat.
- **EOD note, every working day.** One line on each task you touched: what moved, what is next. Brad reads these instead of asking you for status.
- **Never say done over chat.** Done is a status on The Bench. Anything else is a rumour.
- **Ask early.** A question at step one costs a minute. The same question at step eight costs a day of rework. There are no stupid questions in the notes, only late ones.
- **Write for the next person.** Notes should let another builder pick up the task without talking to you.
- **Client contact is not yours.** You do not message clients unless the task says so and Brad has set it up. Client facing words follow the comms rules in EW-TECH-03.

THE ONE EXCEPTION

If Brad is unreachable and a P1 client system is down, hit Blocked with the full detail, then message Brad directly. That is the only time a direct message replaces the task notes.

07 SOP feedback and what gets you removed

If the SOP is wrong

1

Note it in the task

SOP code, step number, what actually happens, what you did instead.

2

Do it the right way if it is safe

If the correct path is obvious and cannot break a client system, follow it and say so. If there is any doubt, press Blocked.

3

Brad approves the edit

Brad reviews your note at QC, updates the SOP, and publishes a new version. Fixing an SOP counts as real work and is part of the Definition of done.

What gets you removed from the team

The team is small and access is real. These are the lines. Crossing any one of them ends the engagement the same day, per the offboarding steps in EW-TECH-02.

Line	Why it matters
Sharing a password, or asking a client for one	We only ever use proper invites. One shared password can expose a client's whole business.
Going silent on a blocker	A hidden blocker becomes a missed client deadline. Press Blocked, always.
Shipping untested work	Moving a task to Review without testing it as the client would wastes the QC gate and risks a live client system.
Touching the agency account or Stripe	These are never in scope for a contractor. Access to them is never granted, and attempting it is a breach.
Putting a credential in a task, chat, repo or Loom	Once it is written down outside the secrets system it is leaked. See EW-TECH-02.

08 Definition of done and when it goes wrong**Definition of done for this SOP**

- ☐ Onboarding on The Bench is complete and I can see the Work board.
- ☐ I have read this SOP and EW-TECH-02 in full.
- ☐ I can move a task from Claim it to Ready for review with proof in the notes.
- ☐ I have posted an EOD note on every task I touched today.
- ☐ I know the Blocked rule and have used the button at least once, with a full reason.
- ☐ I have never told a client or a chat that something is done.

When it goes wrong

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
My code does not work at login	1. All caps, exact characters, with dashes. 2. Paste it from the message rather than typing. 3. Try a private window.	Brad, directly. You cannot post a note yet.
I finished onboarding but see no tasks	1. Refresh the page. 2. Check the Backlog for an unowned task with Claim it. 3. Check My profile shows your correct name.	Brad, in a direct message the first time. After that, the notes on any task.
My task was sent back and I do not understand the note	1. Re read the SOP step it references. 2. Check the proof you attached shows the whole flow. 3. Ask a specific question in the notes.	Brad, in the task notes.
I cannot reach a client system the task needs	1. Check the invite email, including spam. 2. Check you are in the right sub account. 3. Check EW-TECH-02.	Press Blocked with the detail. Brad grants access.
A client messaged me directly	1. Do not reply with status or promises. 2. Copy the message into the task notes. 3. Wait for Brad's direction.	Brad, in the task notes, same hour.